

WHAT'S INCLUDED

- ✓ Complete Answer Key
- ✓ Full Lesson Plan
- ✓ Common Student Mistakes
- ✓ Teacher Tip
- ✓ Extra Class Activity
- ✓ Extension & Exit Ticket

WORKSHEET INFORMATION

LEVEL	A1
SKILL	Writing
TOPIC	Writing with a / an / the
EXERCISES	5 (1–5)
EST. TIME	40–45 minutes
ANSWER KEY	Included above

ANSWER KEY

1. Look and Write

Personal answers – one sentence per picture using a / an / the. Models: 1 (camera) *She bought a camera.* 2 (coffee) *I would like a coffee.* 3 (book) *He is reading a book.* 4 (lake/mountains) *We visited the mountains.* 5 (bike) *I have a bike.* Check: a / an for one non-specific thing, the for a specific one.

2. Complete the Paragraph

- | | |
|-------|---------|
| 1. a | 6. a |
| 2. a | 7. the |
| 3. an | 8. the |
| 4. a | 9. an |
| 5. a | 10. the |

3. Write Sentences (order the words)

1. This is an interesting book.
2. I saw an elephant at the zoo.
3. She bought a new phone.
4. We visited the Louvre Museum in Paris.
5. He is an engineer.
6. It was a great experience.
7. They live in a small apartment.
8. I need an umbrella.
9. That is the oldest building in the city.
10. She has a cat.

4. Write about the Pictures

Personal answers (2–3 sentences per picture: a library, a beach). Check a / an with singular countable, the with a specific noun or a superlative ('the oldest'), and no article with plurals ('books', not 'the books', unless specific).

5. Write about Your Life

Personal answers. Frames use a / an / the: 'I live in a city / the countryside.' 'I have a dog.' 'I think ... is the most interesting place... because...'. Check the article each time.

Challenge

Students write three more sentences using a, an and the (one of each), then underline the noun after each article.

TEACHING SUPPORT

TEACHER TIP

The Remember box has the whole rule: **a / an** = one thing, not specific; **the** = we both know which one; **no article** = plural or uncountable in general. Before Exercises 2 and 3, ask for each noun: 'Which one? Just one? Or many?'

COMMON STUDENT MISTAKES

- ✗ *She is engineer.*
- ✓ *She is an engineer.*
- ✗ *I saw a elephant.*
- ✓ *I saw an elephant.*
- ✗ *It was a most interesting experience.*
- ✓ *It was an interesting experience. / It was the most interesting experience.*
- ✗ *We visited a Louvre Museum.*
- ✓ *We visited the Louvre Museum.*

EXTRA CLASS ACTIVITY

A, An or The? Sorting Race (8 min)

Give teams 12 noun cards (apple, dog, sun, moon, teacher, books, water, hour, university, museum...). They place each under A / AN / THE / NO ARTICLE and write a short reason. Fastest team with the most correct wins.

LEARNING FOCUS

Objective: Students will be able to write sentences and a short paragraph using a, an and the correctly, and leave out the article with general plural and uncountable nouns.

Success Criteria: I can use 'a' before a consonant sound and 'an' before a vowel sound. I can use 'the' for a specific thing or with a superlative. I can write a short paragraph with the right articles.

Prior Knowledge: Singular / plural nouns; vowel and consonant sounds; a / an from earlier lessons.

LESSON PLAN (40–45 MINUTES)

Level: A1

Skill: Writing

Topic: Writing with a / an / the

Exercises: 5 (1–5)

Est. Time: 40–45 minutes

MATERIALS & PREP

- Printed worksheet copies (1 per student)
- Board for the a / an / the rule

- Pens or pencils

TIME	STAGE	PROCEDURE
5 min	Warm-Up	Hold up or draw an apple and a book. Say 'an apple' and 'a book' and ask why they are different (vowel sound / consonant sound). Then point at the classroom door: 'the door' – there is only one, we both know it.
11 min	Presentation (I Do)	Board three columns. a / an = one thing, first time we mention it, not specific ('I saw a dog.'): use an before a vowel sound (an apple, an hour, an engineer). the = specific – we already know which one, or there is only one, or it is a superlative ('the sun', 'the Louvre', 'the oldest building'). no article = plural or uncountable in general ('I like books.', 'Water is important.'). Model the paragraph (Exercise 2) gaps 1–3 aloud, saying the reason for each. Model Exercise 3 item 5: 'he / is / engineer → He is an engineer.' (vowel sound, one job).
10 min	Guided Practice (We Do)	Class completes Exercise 2 to gap 6 together, giving a reason for each choice. Do Exercise 3 items 1–2 as a class (order the words, choose the article, add capital and full stop).
10 min	Independent Practice (You Do)	Students finish Exercise 2 and complete Exercise 3 alone, then compare in pairs, checking a vs. an by saying the noun aloud.
6 min	Assessment	Review Exercise 3 on the board, students giving the article and the reason. Students then complete the Exit Ticket individually.
5 min	Closure	Students write two sentences from Exercise 5 about their own life and read one to a partner, who checks the article.

FOLLOW-UP / HOMEWORK IDEA

Homework: write a 5-sentence paragraph about a place you visited, using a / an for first mentions and the for specific things.

ANTICIPATED PROBLEMS & SOLUTIONS

Problem: Students choose a / an by spelling, not sound ('a hour', 'an university').

Solution: Say the noun aloud first: 'hour' starts with a vowel *sound* → an hour; 'university' starts with a /j/ sound → a university.

Problem: Students add 'the' to general plural or uncountable nouns ('I like the books', 'The water is important').

Solution: Rule on the board: general plural / uncountable → no article. Contrast 'I like books' (general) with 'the books on my desk' (specific).

FOR EXTRA SUPPORT

Give weaker students the paragraph in Exercise 2 with the reason labelled next to each gap ('first time' / 'we know which one') so they only choose the word.

FOR AN EXTRA CHALLENGE

Students rewrite Exercise 2 changing one 'a' to 'the' where the town becomes specific, and explain the change.

LANGUAGE FOCUS & BOARD NOTES

Grammar: a (consonant sound), an (vowel sound), the (specific / unique / superlative), no article (general plural & uncountable).

Board: I saw a dog. • She bought an orange. • We visited the museum. • I like books.

EXIT TICKET — QUICK CHECK

1. Choose: He is ____ engineer. → *an*

2. Choose: That is ____ oldest building in the city. → *the*

3. Order + article: she / has / cat → *She has a cat.*

TEACHER REFLECTION:

☐ What worked well? ☐ What didn't work? ☐ Who needed extra support? ☐ What will I change next time?